

WHO IS THIS BABY?

TEXT: Hebrews 1:1-3 (NKJV) *“God, who at various times and in various ways spoke in time past to the fathers by the prophets, ² has in these last days spoken to us by His Son, whom He has appointed heir of all things, through whom also He made the worlds; ³ who being the brightness of His glory and the express image of His person, and upholding all things by the word of His power, when He had by Himself purged our sins, sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high.”*

INTRO: Believe it or not, we live in a day when Christmas has become a controversial holiday. If you doubt that statement, just try putting up a manger scene on public property. Or try saying “*Merry Christmas*” instead of the ambiguous, “*Happy Holidays.*” Sometimes it seems as if there are more lawsuits than Christmas carols. Every year more and more people get offended by what were once

considered innocent displays of Christmas cheer.

At the heart of the matter is this truth: Some people are unhappy with Christmas because they want nothing to do with Jesus Christ.

They've heard enough and seen enough, and like Ebenezer Scrooge, they say "*Bah Humbug*" to the baby who slept in "*heavenly peace*," in the manger.

Unhappy people are unhappy within themselves, and until they change on the inside, nothing we do or say will make much difference.

The hostility toward THIS BABY is not a new phenomenon, the first Christmas was met with indifference, unbelief, and (in the case of King Herod) outright hostility. So perhaps it is true that the more things change, the more they stay the same.

Who is THIS BABY and why does the world feel such a need to demean Him? We know who he is! He is Jesus Christ, born of the virgin Mary. This we know, this we believe, and this we proclaim, with all other Christians. He is nothing less than “*God made flesh*” and He lived, and is living among us! THIS BABY was completely man and completely God at the same time! There was no 50/50 thing going on!

In the very opening verses of the epistle to the Hebrews the writer gives us a sevenfold description of who Jesus really is.

Let’s look at it:

I. THIS BABY IS THE HEIR OF ALL THINGS

Hebrews 1:2 “*Whom he appointed heir of all things.*”

To say that God has appointed Jesus heir of all things means that God has given everything to his Son

- The deepest oceans...
- The farthest stars...
- The brightness of the sun...
- The highest mountains...
- The lowest valleys...
- The cattle on a thousand hills...
- All the potatoes under the hills...
- The earth and the fulness thereof...

It all belongs to him. Today it doesn't appear that everything belongs to Jesus because Satan is a squatter who illegally claims the earth as his domain. But in the end Satan will be overthrown and Jesus installed as the rightful king of the universe. Heaven is coming to earth!

It may seem from a brief glance at the scoreboard that Satan is winning in the cosmic struggle between good and evil. But as they say

in the election business, those are just “*partial returns.*” When all the votes are counted, those who stand with Jesus will find themselves on the victorious side.

II. THIS BABY IS THE CREATOR OF THE UNIVERSE

Hebrews 1:2 “*Through whom he made the universe.*” There are really only two choices one can make as one studies the universe.

- 1) Either we believe that everything is the result of infinite time, plus blind chance...
- 2) Or we believe that the universe is the result of God’s divine design...

I happen to believe God’s BABY had a hand in the creation of all we see and experience. This means:

- All true science leads back to THIS BABY...
- All true biology leads back to THIS BABY...

- All true botany leads back to THIS BABY...
- All true chemistry leads back to THIS BABY...
- All true physics lead back to THIS BABY...
- All true geology leads back to the BABY...
- All true astronomy leads back to THIS BABY...

The Father delegated to his Son the work of bringing the universe into being and “*nothing was made except through him.*”

THIS BABY is the Agent of Creation and the Heir of All Things:

- He was there at the beginning and he will be there at the end...
- He is the first and the last...
- He is Alpha and Omega...
- He is the Lord of everything in between...

If we have eyes to see and ears to hear -
Everywhere we turn, we run into Jesus. One
must intentionally close their eyes to keep from
seeing him!

III. THIS BABY IS THE RADIANCE OF GOD'S GLORY

Hebrews 1:3 “*The Son is the radiance of God’s glory.*” The word for “*radiance*” was used for sunlight streaming from the sun. Jesus is the blazing radiance of the glory of God. What sunlight is to the sun, Jesus is to God, and He is to the world. It would be easier to try to separate sunlight from the sun than to separate the Son from God, or from the world.

If you want to know what God is like, look at Jesus. He is the magnificent revelation of God himself. He radiates the glory of God.

Theologians have a word for this. They say the Son is “*co-essential*” with the Father. That means the Father and the Son share the same

essence. The Father is God and the Son is God. One cannot extricate one from the other. To accept one is to accept the other. To reject one is to reject the other!

Not only does THIS BABY radiate the Glory of His Father – All the other sons and daughters of God should be radiating the same light!

IV. THIS BABY IS THE EXACT REPRESENTATION OF GOD'S NATURE

Hebrews 1:3 “*He is the exact representation of his being.*” The phrase “*exact representation*” comes from the Greek word “*character*”, from which we get the English word “*character*.”

Jesus shares in the character of God. This word was used for the impression made by an engraving tool when it was stamped into metal, in order to make a coin. The image on the coin was precisely the image on the engraving tool. The image on the penny in my pocket is the exact same image of the penny in your pocket.

Why? Because it was stamped with an engraving tool.

The writer is vividly describing the fact that THIS BABY was stamped with the image of His Father.

This is why Saint Athanasius (Athen-asis) declared, “*Jesus whom I know as my Redeemer cannot be less than God.*”

The writer say’s, He is the “***radiance of God’s glory***” and the “***exact representation of his being.***” These two expressions taken together are a powerful statement of the Son’s full deity. Theologians refer to Jesus as the “***only-begotten.***” That term means “*one-and-only.*” We can truly say that not only is Jesus the Son of God, he is also God the Son. When we see Jesus Christ, we have seen as much of God as it is possible for us to see.

CONCLUSION:

When we see God, we have seen Jesus. When we see Jesus, we have seen God. The question becomes, “*When people see us, do they see the Father or the Son?*”

Our goal in this Christmas season should be to become “*The exact representation of God’s nature.*”

While we want to spread Christmas cheer, we should focus on releasing His nature in our circles of influence, and in the earth. (We should be bringing Heaven to Houston)

END OF SERMON ONE

V. THIS BABY IS THE SUSTAINER OF ALL THINGS

Hebrews 1:1-3 (NKJV) “*God, who at various times and in various ways spoke in time past to the fathers by the prophets, ² has in these last days spoken to us by His Son, whom He has*

appointed heir of all things, through whom also He made the worlds; ³ who being the brightness of His glory and the express image of His person, and upholding all things by the word of His power, when He had by Himself purged our sins, sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high.”

Last week we talked about:

- This baby is the heir of all things...
- This baby is the creator of the universe...
- This baby is the radiance of God’s glory...
- This baby is the exact representation of God’s nature...

Today I want to begin by talking about this baby being the sustainer of all things. Hebrews 1:3
“He sustains all things by his powerful word.”

There is a vast movement in science today, seeking to discover what holds the universe together. Here is the question that the scientific community would like to answer: What is the

ultimate force in the universe? In layman's terms, what is the power, behind the power, behind the power? Our text makes clear that the answer is not a what but a who. What makes the universe hold together? Jesus Christ is the power behind all power. He holds the universe in place by his powerful Word.

Note, that this is written in present tense. From the six days of creation until this present time, Jesus is sustaining the whole universe. All things hold *“for Him, in Him and by Him.”*

His might is mightier, than the might, of all the mighty men on earth. Just a word from His lips and we would all perish.

Do you realize that if Jesus stopped thinking about us, we would cease to exist? We owe our next breath to the fact that Jesus Christ is thinking about us. Someone said, *“Jesus is the nucleus of creation, and the glue of the galaxies.”*

VI. THIS BABY IS THE SAVIOR OF THE WORLD

Hebrews 1:3 “*He had provided purification for sins.*” The King James version adds the words “*by himself*” after the word “*He.*” “*He, by Himself, had provided.*” Note the tense. It is “*had provided,*” not “*will provide*” or “*is providing.*” He has done everything about forgiving the sins of the human race that He is going to do. This BABY is the savior of the world!

He died once for all sin, and for all time. His death on the cross was the complete payment for our sins. That is why he cried out, “*It is finished.*” He purged us from our sins. We were dirty - He was clean. He became dirty – So that we might be made clean.

This means that all efforts at self-reformation as a means of salvation are doomed to failure. We can clean ourselves up if we like, but it will not help us gain merit with God. It is only by Jesus’

atoning death that we are forgiven by God. To add anything else to the work of Christ is nothing less than blasphemy.

Biblical salvation means trusting Jesus Christ for that salvation. If His death is not enough to make us right with God, then we cannot be made right with God. Luke 2:11 ***“Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you; he is Christ the Lord.”*** Jesus is not a good way to heaven - Or the best way to heaven - He is the only way to heaven!

VII. THIS BABY IS NOW SEATED AT THE RIGHT HAND OF GOD

Hebrews 1:3 ***“He sat down at the right hand of the Majesty in heaven.”*** Jesus sat down when he returned to heaven because his work was done. Nothing can be added to the work that Christ accomplished on the cross.

The ***“right hand of God”*** is the place of highest honor:

- If there were a closer place, He would own it...
- If there were a higher place, He would occupy it...
- If there were another crown, he would wear it....
- If there were another honor, he would have it...

But the “*right hand of God*” is the most powerful throne, and the highest honor in the universe. That’s where Jesus is today.

Since THIS BABY has transitioned to a place of power; He is at the Father’s right hand.

Therefore, we have a friend in heaven who dwells eternally at the throne of God. When we pray, we are talking to THE ONE who is at the very center of all things:

- Jesus reigns from heaven...
- Jesus reigns over the earth...
- Jesus reigns over the devil...

- Jesus reigns over sickness and disease...
- Jesus reigns over the affairs of men...
- Jesus reigns over the elements of nature...
- Jesus reigns over the past, present, and the future...
- Jesus reigns over the very entity of death itself...

Jesus not only reigns over these things but ***“God has given him a name that is above every name, that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord to the glory of God the Father.”*** Philippians 2:9-11

CONCLUSION:

As the ***“Heir of all things”*** THIS BABY who has become an equal with God is:

- The heir of all things...
- The creator of the universe...
- The radiance of God’s glory...
- The exact representation of God’s nature...

- The sustainer of all things....
- The Savior of the world...
- The one seated at God's right hand...

He has become everything to everyone who believes in Him:

- To the architect he is the chief cornerstone...
- To the banker he is the hidden treasure...
- To the baker he is the living bread...
- To the builder he is the sure foundation...
- To the doctor he is the great physician...
- To the educator he is the master teacher...
- To the farmer he is the Lord of the harvest...
- To the florist he is the lily of the valley...
- To the geologist he is the rock of ages...
- The Word of God became flesh...
- The Son of God became man...
- The Lord of all became a servant...
- The righteous one was made sin...

This is not just A BABY this is THE BABY –
Sent from God – Born of a virgin – Lived out a
sinless life – Died a substitutionary death –
Gone into the heart of the earth to land a
knockout punch on the devil – Conquered the
keys of hell and the grave – Conquered death by
His resurrection – Defied earths gravity by
ascending from Bethany's launching pad –
Seated at the right hand of the father – Coming
again!